DISSOLVE TO:

EXT. WOODS - RIVER - DAY

Derek, 17-year-old skater kid sits at the riverbank smoking weed. There's a RUSTLING in the bushes.

DEREK
Drew?

Derek stands up and turns around. Derek sees Sheriff Carter, fifty-something southern Caucasian man, poking around the bushes in the distance.

DEREK (CONT'D)
(Under his breath)
Shit.

Derek quickly tosses the joint from his mouth into the river and takes out his others from his pocket and hides them under a rock.

Sheriff Carter spots him and begins to approach. Derek tries to act normal.

DEREK (CONT'D)
How's it going Sheriff?

SHERIFF CARTER
Oh, it's goin'. You mind me asking what you're doing out here?

DEREK
Oh, I come here a lot. I like to get away from everything... everyone and just think... you know?

SHERIFF CARTER
I know it smells like sticky weed out here. That's what I know. You been smoking son?

DEREK
No Sir. That stuff's bad news. Gateway drug I think they call it.

SHERIFF CARTER
Yeah... Okay.
(beat)
How's your mom? I've been meaning to drop by to check on her.

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DEREK
She's good.

SHERIFF CARTER
Yeah? Good. How about that pretty neighbor friend of hers?

Derek smiles oddly, looking confused.

SHERIFF CARTER (CONT'D)
Jewels, is it?

DEREK
Oh, she's good too Sheriff.

SHERIFF CARTER
Alright, glad to hear it. Tell them both I said hi.

Sheriff Carter tips his hat, turns and walks away.

SHERIFF CARTER (CONT'D)
(looks back)
And Derek, don't let me catch you smoking down here. This ain't Colorado.

DEREK
Oh, don't worry Sheriff, you won't ever catch ME smoking.

Derek watches the Sheriff as he walks off. Then sits back down and pulls his other joints from under the rock. He lights and takes a hit. Suddenly a shadow of someone standing behind him appears. He practically spits out the joint into his hand and quickly rises to his feet.

DEREK (CONT'D)
Sheriff, I'm really sorry. I've been so stressed
(turns around)
and--

REVEAL: Frankie, popular 17-year-old male standing there

DEREK (CONT'D)
What the hell? You stalking me? What do you want?

FRANKIE
Nothing, I just wanted to see how you
(MORE)

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FRANKIE (CONT'D)
were doing?

DEREK
Peachy bro.

Derek puts his joint back in his mouth, taking a few puffs.

FRANKIE
So, have you thought about what I said earlier?

DEREK
What?

FRANKIE
About our friendship?

DEREK
We have no friendship, Frankie. We haven't for a really long time now. Or did you bump your head?

FRANKIE
You know as much as I do everyone needs someone Derek.

DEREK
Really? Well, you're barking up the wrong tree, because I don't need your needy ass. Call Jill or someone.

FRANKIE
(hostile)
Oh okay.

Derek shrugs, taking another hit.

Frankie stands awkwardly with his arms folded trying to hide his bruised ego when his attention drifts somewhere else.

FRANKIE (CONT'D)
(redirecting)
You know, I remember when we were kids hanging out down here. Do you still use that hiding place we had?

Frankie motions to a small cave covered by bushes and weeds.

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DEREK
(nervously)
Nope. Haven't used that spot in years.

Derek's eyes tell a different story.

FRANKIE
Probably still has our old stuff in it.

Frankie begins walking towards the cave, alongside the riverbank.

Derek tosses his joint and jogs up to him, grabbing his arm. Frankie stops angrily looking at Derek's hand on his arm.

FRANKIE (CONT'D)
Don't touch me dude.

Frankie aggressively pulls his arm back.

DEREK
You need to leave Frankie. That's not our hiding spot anymore. It's mine.

Frankie aggressively shrugs Derek's hand off him.

FRANKIE
Whatever bro, it's just a hole, right?

Frankie proceeds. Derek gets in front of him.

FRANKIE (CONT'D)
Derek, you might treat me like a stranger at school, but you've known me for a long time. Get out of my way.

DEREK
What I know is the Frankie I knew back then... is long gone.

Frankie pushes Derek. Derek lightly stumbles. As Frankie tries to pass, Derek punches him in the back of the head.

Frankie retaliates with a punch to Derek's face, and Derek tackles Frankie to the ground. They're rolling around in the dirt, punching each other.

They scuffle to their feet and Frankie begins to lose his balance and Derek shoves him one last time, sending him over the riverbanks' cliff, slamming his head into a rock.

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